

ONGC Established 1956

In its journey as the leading oil and gas exploration company in the world, ONGC, which contributes over 80 per cent of India's oil and gas production, has single-handedly scripted its hydrocarbon saga



FUELLING A NATION

Crude may be flaring above \$70 a barrel but at the swanky headquarters of Oil and Natural Gas Corporation (ONGC) in Delhi, one gets the feeling that oil's well here. And its chairman and managing director R.S. Sharma, 58, has reasons enough to be pleased—despite a Rs 28,225 crore burning hole made by payment of subsidy discount to loss-making oil marketing companies, ONGC has recorded the highest-ever turnover of Rs 63,949 crore, an increase of 6 per cent from last year. It is thus the country's highest profit making company.

Established in 1956, ONGC was just a small department with a handful of geo-scientists from the Geological Survey of India. "Things would have remained the same had not the government led by Jawaharlal Nehru realised the importance of oil and gas exploration for driving rapid industrial development and economic growth," recalls Sharma, who joined the oil major as joint director, finance, in 1988 and has been part of it since then.

A series of discoveries starting from Gujarat to Assam, and a spate of finds of huge oil and gas fields on the western offshore changed the oil scenario of the country, injecting huge confidence into ONGC. From a tiny department to a full-fledged independent entity, today ONGC is a Rs 2,50,000

R.S. Sharma 58, CMD

"Bombay High transformed India's limited upstream sector into a large viable playing field with activities spread here and in global territories."